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AMD Ryzen 5 5600

Filling in the gaps

After nearly a year and a half, AMD is still coming out with 'Zen 3' processors to fill in the gaps across the price stack. Meanwhile, Intel has gone to town and released two whole families of processors and has processors at practically every budget. The AMD Ryzen 5 5600 that we're looking at is the non-X variant to have been recently launched and it's geared to make AMD processors more lucrative for the Indian buyer.

SPECIFICATIONS

The newly released AMD processors come from both, the Vermeer as well as the Cezanne designs. The difference is that Vermeer is the original design meant for desktop configurations whereas Cezanne processors are monoliths which were originally made for laptops. Cezanne processors have a much bigger die and include an integrated graphics processor as well. The Ryzen 5 5600 is a Vermeer design so we're simply seeing a slightly scaled-down version of the AMD Ryzen 5 5600X.

The base multiplier has been dropped by 2x making the base clock of the 5600 to be 3.5 GHz and the boost clock has also been dropped to 4.4 GHz. Aside from these aspects, the two processors are very much alike. One aspect that stood out was that the 5600 also supports ECC memory. All Ryzen 5000 processors have ECC support when paired with either a B550 or an X570 motherboard but they're not validated, and hence, there's no mention of ECC support on the specification pages for these processors. That's not the case with the Ryzen 5 5600.

As for the TDP, the Ryzen 5 5600 is still a 65 W part much like the 5600X and you get 20 PCIe Gen 4.0 lanes from the processor. So the two processors are very much the same with just the clock speeds being dif-



ferent. With the launch of this SKU, we now have a budget-friendly 5600, a 5600G with IGP and a faster 5600X within the same budget range giving customers plenty of choices.

PERFORMANCE

Our CPU benchmark tests begin with Cinebench and in the R20 single-threaded benchmark, we see that the Ryzen 5 5600 scores 572 points which when compared to the 598 that the Ryzen 5 5600X scores, isn't that far behind. In the multi-threaded run, the 5600 scores 4014 and the 5600X scores 4195. Switching the Cinebench R23, we see the 5600 scores 1464 and the 5600X score 1539 in the single-threaded run, whereas, in the multi-threaded run, the 5600 logs 10339 and the 5600X had logged 10803. Across both Cinebench benchmarks, we see that the 5600X is 4.5 to 5 per cent better than the AMD Ryzen 5 5600.

Moving to the compression and decompression benchmark with 7Zip, the 5600 is nearly the same as the 5600X in terms of the compression scores but with decompression, the difference between the two processors widens to 4 per cent. In WinRAR, the two processors score nearly the same.



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In our content creation tests with Blender and V-Ray, the two processors score very much alike with some scenes showing a difference of 4.5 per cent whereas other scenes showing a difference of just 2.5 per cent.

In our day-to-day productivity benchmarks which deal with content consumption, word processing, teleconferencing, spreadsheets, etc., we can see that the two processors only differ by an average of four per cent which again, puts these two very close.

Coming to gaming, we tested several games such as Battlefield V, Civ 6, Borderlands 3, DOOM Eternal and CyberPunk 2077 and found the two processors to be within 2-3 FPS of each other. In DOOM Eternal, the processor scored 378 FPS, in CyberPunk 2077 it scored 148 FPS and in

Battlefield V it scored 224 FPS.

Overall, we're looking at two very similarly specced processors with very similar performance levels. At most, the performance difference between the two is about 4.5 to 5 per cent.

VERDICT

This one really comes down to the price because if the two are similarly priced, then the 5600 will not be picked since the 5600X gives a little extra performance for not that much of an added cost. Having launched one and a half years after the initial Ryzen 5000 family's debut, the Ryzen 5 5600 brings little more than a minor bump in performance. In the end, the retail market price will decide which of the two similarly specced processors gets the popular vote.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

CORES: 6 | THREADS: 12 | GPU CORES: NA | BASE CLOCK: 3.5 GHz | BOOST CLOCK: 4.4 GHz | PROCESS NODE: 7nm | L3 CACHE: 32 MB | L2 CACHE: 512 KB per core | TDP: 65 W.

CONTACT

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